RESEARCH GUIDE · OCTOBER 2026

Where AI work can make real money

We studied 72 business problems that cost companies money every week. This guide shows the 3 best ones for Wanile, in plain words, with pictures.

72 problems found › **17** passed all 6 tests › **10** studied up close › **3** best bets for you

For Muhammad Abdullah, Wanile Technologies

About 20 min read

THE SHORT ANSWER

Sell finished, checked work. Not AI tools.

Software now does simple typing jobs for very little money. **What companies still pay well for is a job that is done, checked and handed back on time, with someone responsible for it.**

These 3 fit Wanile best:

1

Monthly books for groups of small companies

Investment firms buy many small companies. Every month someone must join all their books into one clean report. You do it with AI plus accountants, ready by day 10.

Score 46 out of 70 · US clients

2

Client checks for Australian firms

A new Australian law (live since July 2026) makes lawyers, accountants and real estate agents check every new client. You prepare the checks. Their compliance officer approves.

Score 45 out of 70 · Australian clients

3 **Getting back money insurers did not pay**

US doctors lose money when insurers refuse or underpay claims. You find it, fight for it, and take a share of what comes back. Sold through billing companies.

Score 44 out of 70 · US clients

My advice: start Bet 1. Test Bet 2 in the same 2 weeks. Test Bet 3 after that.

The scores are very close (46, 45, 44). Real talks with buyers should decide the final order. Each bet has a 14-day test later in this guide.

THE BIG IDEA

Typing is cheap now. Owning the result is not.

Think of the work as a ladder. The higher you go, the more people pay.

TOP STEP · STILL PAYS WELL

Own the result

The job is done by a deadline, checked, and a named person signs it.

Example: a US group controller costs $120K to $175K a year. Companies pay that because someone must own the numbers.

▲

MIDDLE STEP · PAID IF TIED TO A RESULT

Check the work

Catch errors, chase missing papers, make judgement calls a tool cannot make.

▲

BOTTOM STEP · NOW VERY CHEAP

Type it in

Read a document and enter it into software.

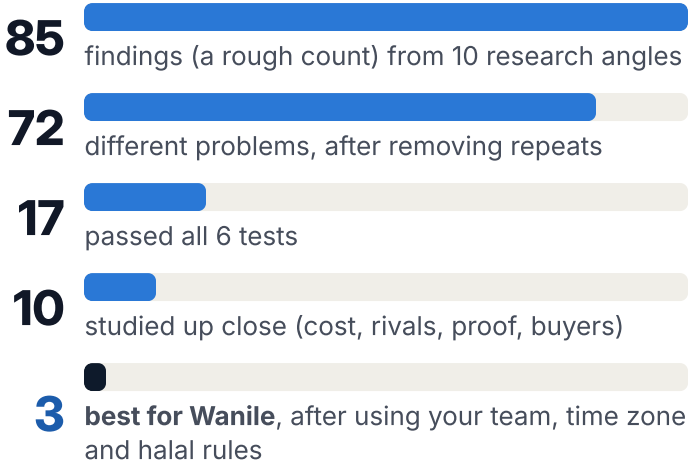
Now about $1 to $2 per order, about $2.75 per faxed referral, and AI phone answering from $29 a month.

In 2025 and 2026, the big software companies added AI for exactly these typing jobs. A service that only types will lose to a free feature. A service that owns a checked result by a fixed date still gets paid.

HOW WE SEARCHED

From about 85 findings down to 3 bets

Ten researchers each looked at business pain from one angle. Then five more studied the top 10 up close.



Bar length shows the real count, so the drop is to scale.

We searched blind on purpose. The researchers did not know who you are or what you like. Your background was used only at the very end, so it could not bend what we found.

41 thrown out

- Failed at least one of the 6 tests

14 parked

- Passed, but scored lower than the top picks

On top of that, 18 new laws were checked and dropped. Courts cancelled some, some were delayed, and some only create work once a year.

THE 10 ANGLES

We looked at business pain from 10 sides

Each angle asks one simple question: where do companies lose money, time or customers every week?

Hard jobs

Jobs companies cannot fill, or pay offshore teams to do by hand.

Money leaks

Money that slips away: unpaid claims, short payments, missed refunds.

Paperwork

PDFs, faxes and emails that someone retypes into a system.

New rules

New laws from 2025 to 2027 that create new weekly work.

Speed

Places where a slow reply loses the sale.

Problems AI made

Fake invoices, fake photos, broken AI-built apps.

Bad software

Old or hated software that forces manual work.

New owners

Companies being bought and merged that need clean numbers fast.

Investor money

Where investors funded AI startups, and which customers those startups ignore.

Buyer posts

What buyers ask for and pay on Upwork and job boards.

THE 6 TESTS

A problem only counted if it passed all 6

1. It happens **every week**.
2. It costs **real money** or customers.
3. Someone **already pays** to deal with it (staff, outsourcing or software).

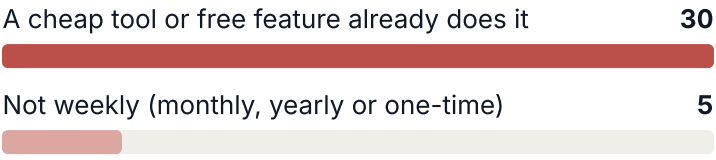
4. The person who feels the pain **can approve spending**.
5. **AI plus a human checker** can do most of it today.
6. **No cheap tool** (under $100 a month) or free feature from Google, Microsoft, Meta, Salesforce, HubSpot or the main industry software already solves it.

Test 6 killed the most ideas. 30 of the 41 rejected problems failed because a cheap tool or a free feature already does the job.

WHAT WE THREW OUT

41 ideas failed. Most because cheap software already does them.

MAIN REASON EACH ONE FAILED



No proof it costs real money **3**

Nobody pays for it today **1**

No one with a budget to say yes **1**

Mostly physical work AI cannot do **1**

Two of the 30 also had no proof of cost.

POPULAR IDEAS THAT FAILED TEST 6

AI phone receptionist	Tools from $29 to $99 a month already answer calls for plumbers and dentists.
Bills into QuickBooks	Built in to QuickBooks, plus $12 to $39 add-ons and a free n8n template.
Support chatbots	Help desk AI costs about $0.99 per solved ticket (not re-checked this time).
Card chargebacks	Chargeflow takes 25% of wins with no minimum, and Stripe has dispute tools.
Fake job candidates	Greenhouse now includes identity checks.
AI video ads	Tools cost about $29 to $110 a month, and it sits close to deepfakes.

Laws that turned out dead or far away: courts cancelled the FinCEN real estate rule and the FTC "click to cancel" rule. The US food tracing rule moved to 2028. Several others only create work once a year.

THE TOP 10, UP CLOSE

Half of them got weaker when we looked closer

Listed by final score. Each has a label and an arrow, so you do not need the colors.

→ Holds

Monthly books for small company groups 46

Big salaries are paid for it. No one sells it as AI plus human for small groups.

↑ Stronger

Australian client checks 45

The law went live in July 2026. Many firms are behind, and the regulator is sending letters.

→ Holds

Insurance money doctors are owed 44

Best-proven pain of all. Very crowded, so only a narrow audit service fits.

→ Holds

Fast price quotes for distributors 42

Big prize: faster quotes win more deals. But quotes must go out within hours in US daytime.

Weaker **Short payments to food brands** 40
A funded startup (Glimpse) already does this with AI plus a Philippines team.

Weaker **Typing purchase orders** 37
More than 15 software tools now do it for about $1 to $2 an order.

Mixed **Customs paperwork** 36
Real pain from tariff changes. But US law keeps the records in the US, and refund work fades by late 2027.

Weaker **Fake bank-change requests** 34
Software comes with $1M loss guarantees, and checks must happen live in US hours.

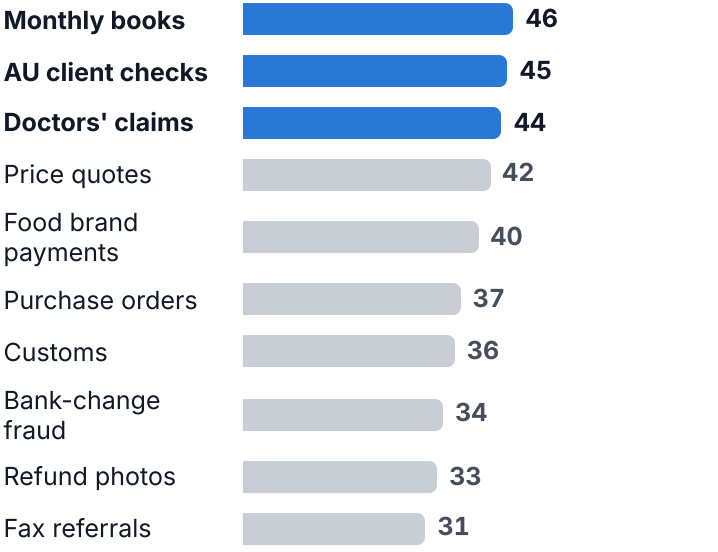
Weaker **AI-faked refund photos** 33
Real, but the loss per brand is small. A $0 to $99 Shopify app blocks much of it.

Weaker **Faxed patient referrals** 31
Main healthcare software now reads faxes itself. Cheap tools cost about $2.75 a referral.

SCORING AGAINST WANILE

Final scores, out of 70

Each problem got 1 to 10 on seven things, then we added them up. Higher is always better.



Bars start at 0. Full width would be 70. Blue = the top 3.

THE SEVEN SCORES BEHIND EACH TOTAL

	Pain	Pay	Reach	Few rivals	Lasts	Fit	Size	Total
Monthly books	7	8	6	4	6	9	6	46
AU checks	7	5	7	5	7	8	6	45
Doctors' claims	8	7	6	3	7	5	8	44
Price quotes	8	6	5	5	7	4	7	42
Food brands	7	7	6	3	5	7	5	40
Purchase orders	6	6	6	3	3	6	7	37
Customs	7	6	6	4	5	4	4	36
Bank fraud	6	4	5	4	5	3	7	34
Refund photos	4	3	5	5	5	6	5	33
Fax referrals	6	5	5	3	3	3	6	31

Pay = willing to pay **Reach** = easy to reach buyer

Lasts = still needed as AI improves **Fit** = fits your team

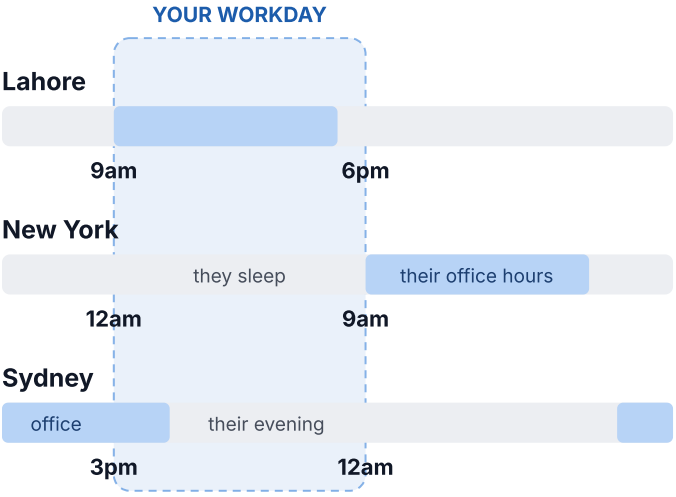
Size = market size Darker blue = higher score

These are judgement calls from the research, not exact measurements.

WHY THE ORDER CHANGED

Your clock decides a lot

The blue band is your normal workday in Lahore. The pale blocks are each city's office hours.



New York: your day is their night. Work is ready when they wake up. Great for deadline work. Bad for anything live.

Sydney: your morning overlaps their afternoon, so you can talk live and still finish files overnight.

New York shown in summer time. From 1 November 2026, New York is 10 hours behind Lahore, so its times move one hour earlier.

Fits your day

- Monthly group books (due by day 10)
- Australian client files
- Insurance appeals and audits
- Deduction disputes

Needs night shifts

- Price quotes within the hour
- Live bank-change call-backs
- Same-day patient intake
- Truck and air customs

WHY THE ORDER CHANGED

Where your team sits matters by law too

US customs	Broker records must stay inside the US, and a licensed US broker must supervise. **This pushed customs down to 7th.**
US health data	US health privacy law (HIPAA) allows offshore work with a signed contract. But Texas Medicaid bars patient data leaving the US, Tennessee needs written consent, and some insurers ask for offshore forms.
Defense parts	Defense drawings cannot be shown to foreign persons (ITAR). This hurt the price-quote idea for machine shops.

Australia	**Good news.** Firms may rely on an outside team under a written agreement. The firm stays responsible, which is exactly a human-in-the-loop service.
US data rule	**Good news.** The US rule on bulk personal data covers only six countries, and Pakistan is not one of them.

That is why price quotes (42) fell to 4th place, even with the biggest dollar prize. Winning there means answering within an hour in US daytime, which is a night shift in Lahore.

BET 1 · US

Monthly books for groups of small companies



WHAT YOU SELL, IN ONE LINE

"Your group's month-end report, cleaned, checked and explained by day 10, signed by a named reviewer."

What is going on

Investment firms (private equity) buy one company. Then they keep buying small ones in the same trade: heating and cooling, vet clinics, dental, IT, accounting. **74.9% of US buyouts so far in 2026 were these add-ons.**

Each new company comes with its own messy books. Every month, someone must join them all into one clean report for the owners. Tools like Fathom and Reach can add up the numbers, but only after a person has cleaned and matched every company's books first. **That cleaning is the pain.**

How the service works

1. **10 to 30 small companies**
   Each has its own QuickBooks or Xero books.
2. **Your team cleans and matches**
   AI maps every account to one group list and flags odd numbers. Accountants fix the errors.
3. **One group report, by day 10**
   With short comments on what changed and why.
4. **A named reviewer signs**
   The client approves the final numbers.

Who pays, and what they pay today

The buyer is the group's CFO or controller, or the CEO in small groups. For people who just bought one business (first-time owners), it is the owner.

$120K to $175K	a year for a group controller (2026 job posts)
$6K to $25K	a month for a part-time CFO (seller's figure)
$1.5K to $4K+	a month for outsourced multi-company bookkeeping (seller's figure)

WHAT YOU COULD CHARGE (ESTIMATE, NOT TESTED YET)

Monthly base fee	**$1,500**
Per company, per month	**$200 to $450**
One-time, per new company added	**$1,500 to $4,000**
First-time owner (one company)	**$1,200 to $2,500 / mo**

A 14-company group pays about $4,300 to $7,800 a month

10 such clients would be about $60K a month. That is still cheaper for them than hiring a controller (about $19K a month all-in).

Why it fits Wanile

- **Monthly deadline, not live work.** Your day shift finishes while the US sleeps.
- **You have built this before.** It is the same kind of work as your bookkeeping agent for the Danish firm.
- **The model is accepted.** Offshore finance teams already serve these investment firms.

How to win clients without cold selling

- **Free 72-hour check:** rebuild last month's group report from their numbers and show what was off.

- **Partner accountants** listed in the Fathom, Reach and Intuit ProAdvisor directories. They sell tools, not the clean-up.
- **ACG events** (58 to 61 chapters) and the investors' operating partners, for referrals.
- **SBA lenders and the SearchFunder community,** for first-time owners.

⚠ Watch out for

- It is getting crowded. One AI accounting group (Crete) plans to spend $500M+ buying accounting firms.
- Each group may later hire its own controller or move to one system.
- Buyers may want a SOC 2 security report and a US CPA name. Plan SOC 2 within 12 to 18 months, or partner with a small US CPA firm.

Halal note (a flag, not a ruling)

Most of these groups carry interest-bearing loans. Doing the company's own books is different from serving the lender. Leave out lender covenant certificates, and ask your scholar.

Your 14-day test

Days 1 to 4	Days 5 to 12	Days 13 to 14
Find 15 names	20-minute calls and the free 72-hour check	Score it

WHO TO TALK TO

CFOs, finance heads and controllers at investor-owned groups with 5 to 30 sites. CEOs of companies just bought by a first-time owner (more than about $3M revenue). Plus 2 or 3 accountants and investors, as partner talks.

HOW TO FIND 15

5 From live job posts for "holding company controller" or "multi-entity controller". Each one is about to spend $160K+ a year on this.

5 From 2025 and 2026 press releases about a "platform investment" and its "first add-on". Pick groups with 5 to 30 sites, not the giants.

5 First-time owners who announced a purchase in the last 6 months on SearchFunder or LinkedIn.

THE 5 QUESTIONS

1 Walk me through last month's close. How many companies, and what day did the report reach your investors?

2. Where did the hours go? Who did the clean-up, and how long did it take?
3. What do you pay for this today, in staff, outside bookkeepers, a part-time CFO and software?
4. What went wrong in the last two reports, and what did it cost you?
5. If an outside team did the first pass with accountant access (no power to make payments) and a named reviewer signed it, what would you need to see before saying yes?

PASS MARK (MY SUGGESTION)

At least 5 of 15 confirm 60+ hours a month on this and $4K+ a month of spend today. At least 3 share real numbers for the free check.

BET 2 · AUSTRALIA

Client checks for Australian law, accounting and real estate firms

45 of 70

WHAT YOU SELL, IN ONE LINE

"We prepare every client check, find who really owns the company or trust, re-check monthly and keep the records. Your compliance officer approves."

What is going on

Australia's money-laundering law (AML/CTF) used to cover mostly banks. **Since 1 July 2026, it also covers lawyers, accountants, conveyancers and real estate agents.** They must now check who every new client really is, and where the money comes from. The regulator, AUSTRAC, expects the businesses it watches to grow from about 19,000 to close to 100,000.

About 50% of accounting practices had signed up by the 29 July deadline. Real estate: 40%. Law firms: 12% to 14%.

28 Aug 2026	AUSTRAC started sending formal notices to firms that had not signed up.
Only 6%	of accountants surveyed felt on top of the rules (survey run by a software seller).
A$23,250	a year: the government's own estimate of ongoing cost for an average small business.

How the service works

1. **A new client walks in**
   A house sale, a new company or trust, or client money held in trust.
2. **The firm sends you the file**
   Under a written agreement, which the law allows.
3. **Your desk does the checking**
   ID check, find the real owners, screen sanction lists, draft the risk rating.
4. **Their compliance officer approves**
   The law says this person must sit inside the firm.
5. **You keep it current**
   Store the records and re-screen clients every month.

WHAT YOU COULD CHARGE (ESTIMATE, NOT TESTED YET)

Per firm, per month	**A$600 to A$1,500**
Set-up or fixing their program	**A$2,500 to A$5,000**
Extra files above the plan	**A$40 to A$120 each**

100 firms at A$800 = about US$52K a month

US dollars at an assumed rate of 1 AUD = 0.65 USD (not checked). Small price per firm, so it only works at volume.

Why it fits Wanile

- **Best clock match on the list.** Your workday covers Sydney's afternoon and evening. Files sent after lunch are ready by morning.
- **The law allows it.** A firm may rely on an outside team under a written agreement.
- **You have proof.** Your compliance AI for a US bank and your legal AI are direct examples.

How to win clients without cold selling

- **Free "AUSTRAC readiness check"** on one real client file.
- **Partners with no human service yet:** a smaller state real estate institute, a practice software or

forms vendor, law society referral lists, the Australian Institute of Conveyancers.

Note: this does not give you the first US client logo you want. It gives you revenue and a strong compliance case study to show US buyers.

⚠ Watch out for

- Small price per firm.
- AUSTRAC promised not to chase small firms over small slips in year one.
- Rivals sit inside tools firms already use: First AML is the real estate body's partner, and InfoTrack works with LEAP.
- Cheap ID-check tools (from US$0.15 a check) and free law society templates.
- Some firms will simply stop offering the covered services.

Halal note (a flag, not a ruling)

Do not take lenders, casinos or bookmakers as clients. Decide up front about precious-metal dealers. Most property sales use interest-based mortgages, which is worth asking your scholar about.

Your 14-day test

Days 1 to 4 Find 15 names

Days 5 to 12 Calls and the free readiness check

Days 13 to 14 Score it

WHO TO TALK TO

Principals and practice managers (they are usually the compliance officer). Plus 2 partner talks: a state real estate institute and a practice software vendor.

HOW TO FIND 15

5 Conveyancers from the Australian Institute of Conveyancers state directories. They are clearly covered.

5 Small accounting firms that set up companies or trusts, from CPA Australia, CA ANZ or IPA "find an accountant" lists.

5 Real estate agencies with 1 to 3 offices from REINSW, REIV or REIQ lists. An "ID check" page on their website is a pain signal.

Directory access was not checked in this research.

THE 5 QUESTIONS

1 Have you signed up with AUSTRAC, and which of your services are covered?

2. Who is your compliance officer, and how many hours a month do client checks take now?
3. How many new covered clients a month, and how many are companies or trusts?
4. What do you use today (a template, First AML, InfoTrack, a consultant), and what does it cost?
5. Would you let an outside team prepare files if your compliance officer approves every risk rating? What would stop you?

PASS MARK (MY SUGGESTION)

At least 5 of 15 spend 8+ hours a month on this. At least 3 would pay A$600+ a month. At least 1 partner wants a pilot.

BET 3 · US

Getting back money insurers did not pay doctors

44 of 70

WHAT YOU SELL, IN ONE LINE

"We check 90 days of paid claims against your insurance contracts and work the old denials nobody touched. You pay a share of what comes back."

What is going on

Insurers refuse some claims (a **denial**). On others they pay less than the contract says (an **underpayment**). Underpaid claims look "paid", so nobody checks them.

48%	of practice leaders said denials are their biggest money leak (MGMA poll, January 2026).
41%	of providers have denial rates of 10% or more (Experian, 2025).
$9.6K to $22K	a month a 5-doctor practice may leave on the table (estimate).

How the service works

1. **A billing company or practice shares data**
   90 days of paid claims, plus their insurance contracts.
2. **AI compares paid vs. promised**
   It finds short payments and sorts the old denials.
3. **Your team writes the appeals**
   Fix and resubmit. This part does not need live calls.
4. **Money comes back**
   You keep a share of what is recovered.

HOW IT MAKES MONEY (ESTIMATE)

Direct to a practice	**20% to 25% of money recovered**
Through a billing company	**about 10% to 15% (a guess)**

Up to $2,400 to $5,500 a month per practice

If you recover everything, at 25%. One billing company with 30 clients multiplies this. Today practices already pay billing firms 4% to 10% of collections, and denial firms 25%.

Why it fits Wanile

- **The work can wait for your day.** Checking contracts and writing appeals do not need live calls.

- **It sells through partners.** The billing companies' association (HBMA) has nearly 500 member firms.
- **The weak spot:** you have no healthcare billing history yet. This is your weakest fit of the three.

⚠ Watch out for

- Very crowded. athenahealth and WebPT launched AI denial tools in mid-2026. Commure/Athelas sells full billing to small practices.
- Sign a business associate agreement (the HIPAA contract). Keep patient data on a US-hosted system with no local copies.
- Avoid Texas and Tennessee Medicaid data unless consent is in place. Be ready for insurers' offshore forms.
- No bots on insurer portals. Availity, a main portal, bans them.

Halal note (a flag, not a ruling)

The money comes from conventional insurers, and a share-of-recovery fee ties your income to insurer money. Please ask your scholar before you start.

Your 14-day test

Days 1 to 4	Days 5 to 12	Days 13 to 14
Find 15 names	Calls and a free 90-day audit offer	Score it

WHO TO TALK TO

Owners and COOs of small billing companies (10 to 60 staff). Practice managers or billing managers at independent doctors' groups.

HOW TO FIND 15

8 Small billing companies from the HBMA member list, state billing groups and LinkedIn searches for "medical billing company owner".

7 Independent groups in eye care, orthopedics, ENT, foot care or physical therapy that are not on athenahealth or WebPT. Skip Texas and Tennessee Medicaid-heavy groups for now.

THE 5 QUESTIONS

1 What share of denials do you actually work, and what happens to the ones nobody touches?

2. Do you check payments against your contract rates today? How often, and who does it?
3. How many people work denials and follow-up, and where are they?
4. What do your client or insurer contracts say about offshore staff and patient data?
5. Would you pay a share of recovered money for a second-look audit of 90 days of claims, under your name? What share feels fair?

PASS MARK (MY SUGGESTION)

At least 4 of 8 billing companies say they do not check underpayments properly. At least 2 agree to a free 90-day audit. None of the contracts you see bans offshore access.

THINGS YOU DID NOT ASK ABOUT

3 surprises from the research

1 Your exact business model already has investor money behind it.

Glimpse, a funded startup, is hiring people in the Philippines to be "the expert human-in-the-loop" behind its AI. Y Combinator's 2026 wish list asks for AI-native agencies that sell finished work, not tools.

So "AI plus humans" alone will not set you apart. Your edge must come from the niche you pick, the partners who send you work, and how trusted your security and compliance are.

2 The famous new laws mostly died. The money is in boring rules with teeth.

Courts cancelled the FinCEN real estate rule and the FTC "click to cancel" rule. The food tracing rule slipped to 2028.

The weekly work sits in rules where someone is already getting sued or warned. Washington's pay-transparency law has drawn 300+ class actions since June 2024. AUSTRAC is already mailing notices.

3 **Where your team sits matters by law, not just by time zone.**

US customs records must stay in the US. Texas Medicaid bars patient data leaving the US. Defense drawings cannot be shown to foreign persons.

But some doors are open: the US bulk data rule does not include Pakistan, and Australia openly allows outside client-check providers.

One more: in February 2026 the US Supreme Court struck down a big set of tariffs. By mid-September, about $134.7B of refunds had been accepted. That created real paid work for customs firms, but it fades by late 2027.

HALAL CHECK

None of the top 3 is ruled out. The care is in which clients you take.

These are flags for your scholar, not rulings.

Bet 1 Books	Groups usually carry interest-bearing loans. Do the company books. Leave out reports made for the lender (covenant certificates).

Bet 2 AU checks	Turn away lenders, casinos and bookmakers as clients. Decide on precious-metal dealers. Property sales often use interest mortgages.
Bet 3 Claims	Income comes from conventional insurers, and the fee is a share of insurer money. Ask before starting. Avoid patient credit plans.

SIMPLE CLIENT SCREENS FOR EVERY BET

- No alcohol-centred brands, importers or distributors.
- No gambling, interest-based lending, adult content or prediction markets.
- Never create fake images or deepfakes, not even to test a detector.

BE CAREFUL

Where the proof is thin

⚠ **How much to trust this**

- Almost every web page was blocked in this research, so the facts come from search result summaries, not full pages.
- Most numbers come from companies that sell a fix.
- There are very few real quotes from business owners.
- Most hours and costs are my estimates, with the math shown in the full report.

Check the key numbers on the original page before you show them to a client.

What would change my mind

Bet 1	Drop it to 2nd if buyers insist on a US CPA firm, are happy with their current offshore team, or will not pay $200+ per company.
Bet 2	Drop it if firm owners say free templates plus First AML or InfoTrack are enough, or if partners say no.

Bet 3	Drop it if billing companies see you as a rival, already check contracts, or their contracts ban offshore access.

What could move up

- **Price quotes** beat Bet 3 if distributors accept next-morning quotes on big project bids, or if you add a US-hours closer.
- **Food brand payments** come back if regional grocers, club stores or non-food brands have pain Glimpse does not cover.
- **Customs** comes back if US customs confirms offshore staff may work inside a US-hosted system.

Never tested (no search budget left): phone and utility bill audits, missed software renewals, quote follow-up, tax refunds, failed card payments, matching customer payments, hiring screens, inbox triage. The UK was barely covered. A better problem could still be hiding there.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Your next 2 weeks

1. **Run Bet 1 and Bet 2 tests at the same time.** Bet 1 is US and in USD. Bet 2 costs little and the clock favours you.

2. **Build the two free checks first:** the 72-hour group report rebuild, and the one-file AUSTRAC readiness check. These are your demos.

3. **Find 15 names for each bet** using the lists on the bet pages.

4. **Book 20-minute calls** and ask the 5 questions. Write down hours, money spent today, and objections.

5. **On day 14, score against the pass marks.** Keep the bet that passes. Start Bet 3 tests after that.

> **Start the trust work early.** A SOC 2 report, written agreements, US-hosted systems and a named reviewer will win your first US client faster than a better AI agent will.

WORDS EXPLAINED

Simple meanings

Private equity (PE) group, or roll-up
An investment firm buys one company, then keeps buying small similar companies and joins them together.

Add-on
Each smaller company bought after the first one.

Monthly close
Finishing the month's books so the numbers are final.

Consolidation
Adding every company's numbers into one group report.

Chart of accounts
The list of categories a company uses in its books.

First-time owner (search fund or SBA buyer)
A person who buys one small business, often with a loan from the SBA, a US government-backed loan program.

AML/CTF
Rules against money laundering and terror financing.

Client checks (CDD)
Checking who a client really is and where their money comes from.

AUSTRAC
Australia's government body that enforces these rules.

Denial / underpayment
The insurer refuses to pay a claim / pays less than the contract says.

Share of recovery (contingency)
You only get paid a part of the money you win back.

White-label
You do the work, but your partner sells it under their own name.

Billing company
A firm that handles insurance billing for doctors.

RFQ
Request for quote: a buyer asks for a price.

ERP
A company's main business software for orders, stock and money.

SOC 2
A security audit report US buyers often ask vendors for.

HIPAA
The US law that protects patient data.

ITAR
A US rule that controls who may see defense-related data.

KEY SOURCES

Where the main numbers come from

Tap a link to open it. The full report has about 200 more.

BET 1

Controller job post, up to $160K + bonus (Jan 2026): pcrecruiter.net

Add-ons were 74.9% of US buyouts (PitchBook data): claconnect.com

13,509 US PE-backed companies: pennmutualam.com

Fathom needs each company imported first: support.fathomhq.com

Crete plans $500M+ of accounting firm buys: finance.yahoo.com

BET 2

Enrolment rates and AUSTRAC notices: clydeco.com

Firms may rely on an outside team: austrac.gov.au

From about 19,000 to close to 100,000 businesses: austrac.gov.au

Only 6% of accountants on top of the rules: accountingtimes.com.au

A$23,250 a year government cost estimate: scantek.com

BET 3

48% say denials are the biggest leak (MGMA): physicianspractice.com

Offshore patient data limits: shumaker.com

Availity bans portal bots: availity.com

HBMA has nearly 500 member firms: hbma.org

OTHER KEY FACTS

US customs records must stay in the US: law.cornell.edu

Glimpse hiring humans-in-the-loop: ph.indeed.com

Fast quotes win (distributor case study): instalily.ai

Fax referral tool pricing: capterra.com

IEEPA tariff refunds: chrobinson.com

Made from the full research report "AI ops open problem discovery" (27 October 2026). Money in USD unless marked A$.